

Research Note:

Passion for work, but tensions at home? The effect of self-employment in double-earner households

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The data collected by the German Family Panel pairfam are accessible to the scientific community as scientific use file for scholarly analyses.

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Abstract

In this research note, we examine whether self-employment in double-earner couples is associated with relationship tensions through passion for work. While self-employed individuals are generally more passionate about their work than paid employees, prior research reveals such passion can have negative spillover effects on private life. Along this view, passion for work may account for relationship tensions between the self-employed and their partners, who deal with its consequences. Analyzing over 4,000 observations of double-earner couples from the German Family Panel, we find that self-employed individuals report significantly higher passion for work than paid employees. At the same time, self-employment is a source of work-family conflict. Specifically, experiences of relationship tension are positively associated with having a self-employed partner. This association is accounted for by the degree of passion said partners dedicate to their work, suggesting passion for work may act as an important behavioral mechanism underlying work-family conflicts. This research note calls for attention to partners' roles in the household context and reveals a potential dark side of self-employment, whereby its demands and commitments can detract from involvement in private life.

Keywords

self-employment; tensions; relationships; work passion

1. Introduction

The self-employed are said to be passionate about their businesses (see for review Newman et al., 2021; Taggar et al., 2024). In entrepreneurial households, however, the boundaries between business and private life intersect (Carter et al., 2017). Passion for work, thus, may bleed into the private domain. Following literature proposing that self-employment, with its attendant effects on behavior and environment, has a “dark side” (see e.g., Kets de Vries, 1985; Miller, 2015; Shepherd, 2019), we examine whether self-employed individuals may be inciting greater work-family conflicts through the inadvertent passion they demonstrate for their work (Jennings & McDougald, 2007; Newman et al., 2021).

The self-employed are more satisfied with their jobs than paid employees (e.g., Blanchflower, 2000; Schneck, 2014), perceive their work as meaningful (Stephan et al., 2020), and benefit from work autonomy (Benz & Frey, 2008a). Thus, being self-employed can become a real passion. In fact, the literature shows that the self-employed work long hours and that the self-employed often prioritize work over leisure (Blanchflower, 2004; Hyytinen & Ruuskanen, 2007). However, the benefits of being passionate at work may be accompanied by time constraints for other domains of life, which creates opportunities for work-family conflicts to arise.

The prioritization of work over leisure might spill over into the domestic relationship. In this regard, Yu et al. (2026) present evidence that entry into self-employment lowers the partner’s well-being through longer work hours in self-employment. Thus, there seems to be a direct effect from one partner to the other when one of the partners becomes self-employed. Moreover, Kalantari (2024) shows that having a self-employed partner is associated with lower life satisfaction, which is significantly lower when both partners are self-employed. This spillover may occur because self-employment often merges with private life, requiring domestic partners to provide continuous social resources and support (Arregle et al., 2015; Cogan et al., 2022). Schneck (2026) further shows that individuals report more disagreements and quarrels when the partner is self-employed, which is explained by the partner’s interference in private decisions. Taken together, there is ample evidence that self-employment might affect not only the self-employed individual but also the partner. We therefore contribute to the recently emerging literature addressing whether and how self-employment affects the partner.

Alshibani et al. (2024, 2025), Kalantari (2024), and Yu et al (2026) present evidence that having a self-employed partner or having a partner entering self-employment decreases individual well-being. Schneck (2026) adds that having a self-employed partner fosters disagreement and quarrel in domestic relationships. Extending these findings, in this paper, we analyze whether passion for work among the self-employed is a source of relationship tension. Our analysis is based on unique German panel data, which enables the examination of the relationship between passion for work and work-family conflicts. The panel estimates, consisting of more than 4,000 observations, reveal that passion for work is higher among the self-employed than among paid employees. Moreover, we show that relationship tensions are not correlated with respondent employment status but positively correlated with partner self-employment status. This implies that not the *own*, but rather the *partner’s* self-employment is associated with tensions in domestic relationships (also see Schneck, 2026). Finally, we examine whether the partner’s passion for work helps describe the tensions associated with having a self-employed partner. Our estimates, indeed, suggest that a partner’s passion for work helps explain tensions associated with having a self-employed partner.

2. Data and Methods

The analysis is based on the German Family Panel, also known as the Panel Analysis of Intimate Relationships and Family (pairfam).¹ The panel started in years 2008/2009 with more than 12,000 respondents. The target population consists of German-speaking individuals living in private households in Germany who belong to the birth cohorts 1971-1973, 1981-1983, and 1991-1993 (Brüderl et al., 2022b). In wave 11 (2018/2019), new anchors of the birth cohort 2001-2003 and a refreshment sample were added. Anchors are asked for consent to the participation of partners. If permitted, partners answer a shorter questionnaire, allowing for dyadic analysis by joint examination of anchor and partner data sets. In our final panel data set, anchors and their partners are treated as different actors, meaning the term “partner” in the remainder of our analysis is not restricted to the partner data but refers to all respondents. Specific details about the concepts, design, and survey methods are presented in Brüderl et al. (2022a, 2022b) and Huinink et al. (2011).

The data set contains questions addressing tensions in domestic relationships. In this paper, we concentrate on self-assessments regarding whether a relationship was in jeopardy. The original survey question was, "Since [date of interview/previous wave] have you ever thought that your relationship or marriage was in trouble?"² Responses are binary (yes or no), and the question has been included in all panel waves. The data is restricted to relationships in which the partners' primary activity status is either employed full-time or self-employed.

Passion for work refers to the question of whether the following statement applies to the respondent: "The time I need for my partner, family, and friends keeps me from being more involved in my job, vocational training, or university education". The answer is based on a 5-item Likert scale from 1 (not at all) to 5 (absolutely). Our question follows the logic of time-based measures of work-family conflict as defined by Greenhaus & Beutell (1985), with the underlying idea being that time devoted either to work or to family makes it difficult to fulfill the requirements of the other role. We interpret higher values as indicating that individuals place more weight on work than they do on the family. This makes higher values consistent with more passion for work, as the motivational pull to work and its importance relative to other aspects of life are its defining aspects (see e.g., Vallerand et al., 2003; Baum & Locke, 2004; Cardon et al., 2009; Chen et al., 2020). This question was included in waves 6, 8, 10, and 12 of our panel data, and both partners were asked. For this reason, we can examine not only the partner's self-employment status, but also assign the individual level of weight on the job versus the family. Here, the restriction to individuals either full-time employed or self-employed, i.e., belonging to double-earner relationships, helps to identify the effects of the work sphere rather than vocational training or education. Moreover, due to our focus on individuals in domestic relationships, we narrow the scope of the effects on partners and families.

The final data set analyzed in this study is restricted to relationships where both partners are either self-employed or full-time employed. Hence, we restrict the data to double-earner relationships to locate the most distinctive match regarding tensions originating from the work sphere. The sample is additionally restricted to individuals aged between 18 and 65. Because of

¹ We utilize version 13.0.0: doi.org/10.4232/pairfam.5678.13.0.0 (accessed on Aug. 25, 2026).

² An alternative formulation, if required, was: "Since the start of your relationship, have you ever thought that your relationship or marriage was in trouble?"

missing information, we do not necessarily consider both partners in the final sample, but we include the respondents for whom we have all the required information.

We apply ordered probit models to explain the correlation between self-employment and passion for work. Moreover, we use probit models to examine tensions, which are measured by a binary variable (yes/no). Since we cannot observe individually innate abilities, preferences, or factors affecting the choice of the job, we need to account for time-invariant unobserved heterogeneity. In the ordered probit model, however, the application of fixed-effects estimation is not feasible. We, therefore, estimate hybrid (ordered) probit models (Schunck, 2013; Schunck & Perales, 2017), where we split the effects of individually varying covariates on the outcome variable into within-cluster and between-cluster effects (equation (1)). β_1 refers to the individual within-cluster effects (i.e. fixed-effect) of variables on the outcome. β_2 addresses the between-cluster effects (i.e. random-effects). β_3 refers to the effects of time-invariant explanatory variables. In Equation (1), index i denotes individuals and t stands for time. u_i is the random intercept, and e_{it} describes the error term.

$$y_{it} = \beta_0 + \beta_1(x_{it} - \bar{x}_i) + \beta_2 \bar{x}_i + \beta_3 z_i + u_i + e_{it} \quad (1)$$

In particular, we estimate a Mundlak-type random-effects, fixed-effects regression for (ordered) probit models (Mundlak, 1978). This enables us to approximate fixed-effects estimates while preserving all the important information of the average effect of the employment status. In the following analysis, we present within-cluster effects, which represent the effects of changes in variables. The within-cluster effect thus describes the effect of a change from paid employment to self-employment. The between-cluster effects present the effects of the respondent's and partner's employment status and level of passion, respectively. Standard errors are clustered at the individual level.

We assess whether the partner's passion for work helps explain the effect of having a self-employed partner by comparing two specifications. The baseline specification only includes whether the partner is self-employed, while the extended specification additionally accounts for the partner's level of passion for work.³ When the between-effect of having a self-employed partner in the baseline specification is significant and becomes insignificant in the extended model, then the tensions associated with having a self-employed partner can be explained by the partner's passion for work. However, comparing nested nonlinear models such as ordered probit models with different functional forms is not straightforward due to the rescaling problem (Schunck & Perales, 2017). We, therefore, look at changes in the significance levels of already existing variables in nested models (also see Schunck & Perales, 2017; Schneck, 2026). Besides, effects of hybrid (ordered) probit models are not intuitively interpretable. Therefore, we additionally present the results of linear Mundlak correction models. Ultimately, these models serve as robustness checks of the hybrid (ordered) probit models, with the advantage that the effect sizes are intuitively interpretable and can be compared across different specifications.

To isolate the effects of passion for work and self-employment on relationship tensions, we include a rich set of covariates in our estimates. At the individual level, we account for the sex and age of respondents, including an additional squared term (age squared) to capture non-linear effects. Recognizing that economic (in)dependence and financial inequality are significant stressors for couples (Rogers, 2004; Fan et al., 2019; Eads et al., 2023), we include the log of individual net labor income, the log of net household income, and a dummy variable for breadwinner status (defined as contributing >50% of total household net income). Furthermore,

³ See Benz & Frey (2008b) and Lange (2012) for similar estimation strategies in another context.

we control for relationship-specific factors, including marital status, relationship length (in months), and the number of children living in the household. To address the effects of broader sociodemographic heterogeneity, we account for migration background and educational attainment (Eads et al., 2023). Finally, we include panel wave and federal states fixed effects to control for any temporal and regional variation during our analytic period. See Table AI in the Appendix for descriptive statistics.

3. Results

First, we examine whether self-employed and employees differ in their passion for work. On average, the respondents report relatively low levels of family interference with work (mean 1.564, see Table AI in the Appendix). Thus, in most cases, partners and family are prioritized over work. However, the self-employed report a significantly higher level of passion for work than employees, even after controlling for an exhaustive set of individual and household characteristics (Table I; between-cluster effects), indicating that the self-employed are more passionate about their work than employees. The between-effect of 0.398 suggests that a self-employed individual has a 0.4 points higher passion for work than paid employees (see specification (2)). When considering the average value of passion, this corresponds to a relative markup of 25.4% ($=0.398/1.564*100\%$). This is evidence that the self-employed indeed are likely to put considerably more weight on the job than on the family when compared to paid employees (Blanchflower, 2004). The within-cluster effects of self-employment, however, are insignificant. Entering self-employment, thus, has no clear effect on passion for work. In addition, tests suggesting the use of a standard random-effects ordered probit model and assuming orthogonality between observable and unobservable characteristics are rejected for self-employment and the interaction term.

Table I: Estimates explaining passion for work.

Variables	(1) Hybrid ordered probit model	(2) Linear Mundlak model
<i>Within-cluster effects</i>		
Self-employed (within)	0.124 (0.247)	0.068 (0.136)
Partner is self-employed (within)	0.043 (0.260)	-0.012 (0.116)
Both partners self-employed (within)	0.917 (0.601)	0.604* (0.334)
<i>Between-cluster effects</i>		
Self-employed (between)	0.675*** (0.134)	0.398*** (0.080)
Partner is self-employed (between)	0.144 (0.121)	0.061 (0.062)
Both partners self-employed (between)	-0.206 (0.284)	-0.057 (0.174)
Control variables	included	included
Number of observations	4,312	4,312
Number of individuals	2,649	2,649
Log-pseudolikelihood	-4,039.0	-5,027.6

Dependent variable: Time for partner etc. restrains me from engaging more in work. 1 (not at all) ... 5 (absolutely).

Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at individual level.

Control variables: age in years (plus squared term), log of individual net labor income, log of net household income, number of children living in the household, duration of relationship in months, dummy variables for breadwinner (>50% of total household net income), wave, federal states, marital status, education, migration background, male, at least one person below the age of 14 in main residence.

Estimates were conducted with Stata SE (17.0) and command *xthybrid* with options *family(ordinal)* and *link(probit)* as well as the options *family(gaussian)* and *link(identity)*.

*** $p < 0.01$, ** $p < 0.05$, * $p < 0.1$.

Twenty percent of respondents reported that the partnership was in serious trouble last year (mean 0.203, see Table AI in the Appendix). Tensions are not correlated with own employment status but positively correlated with the partner's self-employment status (specification (1) in Table II; between-cluster effects). This implies that the self-employed and employees are similar when it comes to complaining about tensions. However, when their partner is self-employed, respondents are more likely to complain about tensions than respondents with employed partners. Litsardopoulos & Saridakis (2022) report a harmony-enhancing effect in dual self-employed couples. We, however, cannot identify a clear-cut effect when both partners are self-employed because the corresponding effects are insignificant. All the presented work-related within-cluster effects are insignificant, implying that employment status

changes do not affect tensions significantly. The work-related coefficients of the linear model are robust to those of the hybrid probit model.

Table II: Estimates explaining tensions.

Variables	(1) Hybrid probit model	(2)	(3) Linear Mundlak model	(4)
<i>Within-cluster effects</i>				
Self-employed	-0.130 (0.528)	-0.120 (0.528)	-0.011 (0.072)	-0.010 (0.072)
Partner is self-employed	0.183 (0.438)	0.168 (0.438)	0.028 (0.070)	0.027 (0.070)
Both partners self-employed	0.884 (0.918)	0.854 (0.914)	0.179 (0.166)	0.175 (0.165)
Partner's response to: time for partner etc. restrains me from engaging more in work: 1 (not at all) ... 5 (absolutely)		0.056 (0.068)		0.008 (0.011)
Ln(net labor income)	0.263 (0.245)	0.266 (0.246)	0.032 (0.036)	0.032 (0.036)
Breadwinner	0.193 (0.159)	0.197 (0.159)	0.030 (0.023)	0.030 (0.023)
Age	-0.392** (0.180)	-0.397** (0.180)	-0.067** (0.028)	-0.066** (0.028)
Age squared	0.001 (0.002)	0.001 (0.002)	0.000 (0.000)	0.000 (0.000)
Ln(household net income)	-0.567** (0.251)	-0.567** (0.251)	-0.084** (0.036)	-0.084** (0.035)
Tenure of relationship	0.017*** (0.005)	0.017*** (0.005)	0.003*** (0.001)	0.003*** (0.001)
Married/civil union	-0.522** (0.240)	-0.523** (0.240)	-0.077** (0.039)	-0.077** (0.039)
Divorced/dissolved civil union	-0.196 (0.493)	-0.192 (0.492)	-0.030 (0.099)	-0.030 (0.098)
Number of children living in the household	-0.038 (0.198)	-0.046 (0.198)	-0.011 (0.030)	-0.012 (0.030)
At least one person below the age of 14 in main residence	-0.198 (0.228)	-0.203 (0.228)	-0.026 (0.034)	-0.027 (0.034)
<i>Between-cluster effects</i>				
Self-employed	-0.022 (0.195)	-0.029 (0.195)	-0.003 (0.031)	-0.004 (0.031)
Partner is self-employed	0.350* (0.185)	0.280 (0.186)	0.057* (0.031)	0.046 (0.031)
Both partners self-employed	-0.339 (0.455)	-0.326 (0.450)	-0.045 (0.078)	-0.041 (0.076)
Partner's response to: time for partner etc. restrains me from engaging more in work: 1 (not at all) ... 5 (absolutely)		0.159*** (0.059)		0.025** (0.010)
Ln(net labor income)	-0.229 (0.157)	-0.225 (0.158)	-0.034 (0.027)	-0.034 (0.027)
Breadwinner	0.049 (0.134)	0.046 (0.134)	0.002 (0.021)	0.002 (0.021)
Age	-0.069 (0.052)	-0.071 (0.052)	-0.012 (0.009)	-0.012 (0.009)
Age squared	0.001 (0.001)	0.001 (0.001)	0.000 (0.000)	0.000 (0.000)
Ln(household net income)	0.230 (0.172)	0.229 (0.172)	0.035 (0.029)	0.036 (0.029)
Tenure of relationship	-0.002** (0.001)	-0.002** (0.001)	-0.000** (0.000)	-0.000** (0.000)
Married/civil union	-0.728*** (0.133)	-0.718*** (0.133)	-0.115*** (0.020)	-0.113*** (0.020)
Divorced/dissolved civil union	0.154 (0.251)	0.169 (0.251)	0.033 (0.046)	0.035 (0.046)
Number of children living in the household	0.207** (0.084)	0.191** (0.084)	0.030** (0.014)	0.028** (0.014)
At least one person below the age of 14 in main residence	0.112 (0.164)	0.094 (0.164)	0.020 (0.026)	0.017 (0.026)

Time-invariant variables

Male	-0.121 (0.098)	-0.135 (0.098)	-0.015 (0.016)	-0.018 (0.016)
First generation migrant	0.301 (0.187)	0.297 (0.186)	0.046 (0.032)	0.045 (0.032)
2nd generation migrant	0.115 (0.173)	0.110 (0.173)	0.019 (0.027)	0.019 (0.027)
Widowed/surviving partner in civil union	-8.594*** (0.554)	-7.893*** (0.555)	-0.254*** (0.037)	-0.245*** (0.036)
Control variables	included		included	
Number of observations	4,312	4,312	4,312	4,312
Number of individuals	2,649	2,649	2,649	2,649
Log-pseudolikelihood	-1,933.5	-1,929.5	-1,894.8	-1,891.1

Dependent variable: Your relationship or marriage was in trouble? 0 (no); 1 (yes).

Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at the individual level.

Control variables: respondent's education, federal state, and wave.

Estimates were conducted with Stata SE (17.0) and the command *xthybrid* with options family(binomial) and link(probit) as well as the options family(gaussian) and link(identity).

*** p < 0.01, ** p < 0.05, * p < 0.1.

Complaints about trouble in relationships are positively correlated with the partner's degree of passion for work (specifications (2) and (4) in Table II; between-cluster effect). A partner's work passion is also positively correlated with tensions. Thus, the higher the partner's level of passion for work, the higher the likelihood of tensions. However, changes in the partner's passion for work are not significantly correlated with tensions.

We show that the partner's self-employment status is significantly and positively correlated with tensions in domestic relationships (specifications (1) and (3); between-cluster effects). The effect of self-employment is not only significant in statistical terms, but also from a quantitative perspective. Having a self-employed partner increases the likelihood of the relationship was in trouble by 5.7 percentage points (cf. specification (3)). Based on the mean, having a self-employed partner increases the likelihood of tensions by 28.1% ($5.7/20.3 \times 100\%$). The statistical significance of the effect of the partner's self-employment disappears when the passion for work of the partner is accounted for (compare specifications (1) vs. (2) and (3) vs. (4)). The significant effect of self-employed partners on tensions, therefore, can be explained by the passion for work of partners. Based on a comparison of specifications (3) and (4), the effect of having a self-employed partner decreases by 19.3% ($(0.057 - 0.046) / 0.057 \times 100\%$) when additionally accounting for the partner's passion for work.

Regarding the control variables, only a few variables are statistically significant, which highlights the importance of the job dimension in tensions between partners. Among the within-cluster effects, age, household income, and marriage are estimated to be significant. Specifically, increases in household income as well as getting married are associated with lower tensions. An additional month of tenure increases the likelihood of tensions, but the associated between-effect of tenure of the relationship suggests that longer relationships are subject to slightly less tensions. Being married is also associated with less tensions compared to never being married but having a partner. In addition, tensions are often related to having children.

4. Discussion

Passion for work is closely linked with various entrepreneurial outcomes (Newman et al., 2021). We show that having a self-employed partner is positively correlated with tensions in relationships. When accounting for the partner's passion for work, the significant effect of the self-employed partner disappears, indicating that passion for work may underlie the tensions associated with having a self-employed partner. We therefore contribute to the emerging literature explaining that having a self-employed partner is linked to lower life satisfaction and psychological well-being (Alshibani et al., 2024, 2025; Kalantari, 2024; Yu et al., 2026) as well as a higher degree of tensions (Schneck, 2026). We add that a self-employed partner exhibiting more passion for work is associated with a higher likelihood that their spouse reports relationship trouble. These results suggest that the self-employed often devote themselves extensively to their work, frequently at the expense of their domestic relationships. Own self-employment, however, is not significantly related to tensions in relationships. We also find no clear-cut tense effects when both partners are self-employed.

Our analysis examines the intricate dyadic nature in entrepreneurial households with a focus on passion for work, though its limitations should be considered. Our measure of passion might be subject to critique since the partners do not cross-validate whether the partners put more weight on family or the job. Such a cross-validation would also include the partner's subjective perceptions about the spouse's passion for work, which ultimately might better describe the sources of tensions. Our results also highlight the importance of analyzing different forms of work passion, which may necessitate a diversity of measures. Our applied indicator for work passion likely refers to egoistic or obsessive forms of passion (Shane et al., 2003; Houlihan et al., 2018), as opposed to positive affect (Cardon et al., 2013). It is also possible that passion for work might stem from talent and the quality of the job fit or the personal meaning of the job (practical, social, monetary, etc.) that reinforce the attitude of prioritizing work over the partner. Besides, other reasons, such as financial needs, business needs, or norms and habits, might be responsible for the prioritization of work over the partners and families. Furthermore, alternative interpretations of our main measure must be considered. Our measure might instead track frustration with family demands or the general perception of work-family conflict, rather than work prioritization out of passion itself. More specifically, an individual might prefer working long hours to reduce time spent with the partner. We therefore encourage future research aimed at disentangling these different dimensions of allocating time between work and family.

Despite considerable efforts in (behavioral) household economics (Hopfensitz & Munro, 2020; Apps & Rees, 2023), we are still in need to better understand the dyadic nature in relationships. For example, consider partners with different expectations about how to reach work-family balance. On one hand, one partner might expect that a self-employed person is able to restrain from engaging more in work because the self-employed have more freedom to choose how much they work. On the other hand, there could be a passionate person who enjoys self-employed work and is willing to prioritize work over the family. Such conflicting expectations, especially at the work-family interface, could prove to be a source of tension in relationships. We therefore encourage research on work-related expectations in dyadic relationships, particularly with regard to how these expectations develop. Additionally, the consequences of mismatched expectations between partners are an interesting avenue for future research.

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Appendix

Table AI: Descriptive statistics

	Mean	Standard deviation	Minimum	Maximum
Your relationship or marriage was in trouble? 0 (no); 1 (yes).	0.203	0.402	0	1
Passion for work [Time for partner etc. restrains me from engaging more in work. 1 (not at all) ... 5 (absolutely).]	1.564	0.853	1	5
Partner's response to: time for partner etc. restrains me from engaging more in work: 1 (not at all) ... 5 (absolutely)	1.567	0.866	1	5
Paid employee	0.909	0.288	0	1
Self-employed	0.091	0.288	0	1
Partner is paid employee	0.905	0.293	0	1
Partner is self-employed	0.095	0.293	0	1
Both partners self-employed	0.019	0.137	0	1
ln(net labor income)	7.568	0.504	4.32	11.16
Breadwinner	0.465	0.499	0	1
Male	0.500	0.500	0	1
Age	37.050	7.760	20	64
Age squared	1,432.875	583.482	400	4,096
Education				
inadequately completed	0.003	0.053	0	1
general elementary education	0.010	0.102	0	1
basic vocational qualification	0.064	0.244	0	1
intermediate vocational qualification	0.345	0.475	0	1
intermediate general qualification	0.010	0.101	0	1
general maturity certificate	0.023	0.149	0	1
vocational maturity certificate	0.173	0.378	0	1
lower tertiary education	0.113	0.316	0	1
higher tertiary education	0.260	0.439	0	1
Migration status				
No migration background	0.865	0.341	0	1
1st generation	0.061	0.239	0	1
2nd generation	0.074	0.261	0	1
ln(household net income)	8.279	0.410	4.83	11.23
tenure of relationship (months)	142.469	94.436	1	408
Marital status				
Never married	0.353	0.478	0	1
Married/civil union	0.606	0.489	0	1
Divorced/dissolved civil union	0.040	0.196	0	1
Widowed/surviving partner in civil union	0.000	0.022	0	1

Number of children living in the household	0.837	0.992	0	6
At least one person below the age of 14 in main residence	0.380	0.485	0	1
Wave				
Wave 6	0.263	0.440	0	1
Wave 8	0.237	0.425	0	1
Wave 10	0.210	0.408	0	1
Wave 12	0.290	0.454	0	1
Region				
Schleswig-Holstein	0.038	0.192	0	1
Hamburg	0.011	0.104	0	1
Niedersachsen (Lower Saxony)	0.096	0.295	0	1
Bremen	0.006	0.074	0	1
Nordrhein-Westfalen (North Rhine-Westfalia)	0.126	0.332	0	1
Hessen (Hesse)	0.071	0.258	0	1
Rheinland-Pfalz (Rhineland-Palatinate)	0.026	0.160	0	1
Baden-Württemberg	0.071	0.256	0	1
Bayern (Bavaria)	0.131	0.337	0	1
Saarland	0.002	0.046	0	1
Berlin	0.048	0.214	0	1
Brandenburg	0.081	0.273	0	1
Mecklenburg-Vorpommern (Mecklenburg- Western Pomerania)	0.035	0.183	0	1
Sachsen (Saxony)	0.115	0.319	0	1
Sachsen-Anhalt (Saxony-Anhalt)	0.078	0.268	0	1
Thüringen (Thuringia)	0.064	0.246	0	1
Number of observations	4,312			